

Hydration of Cement

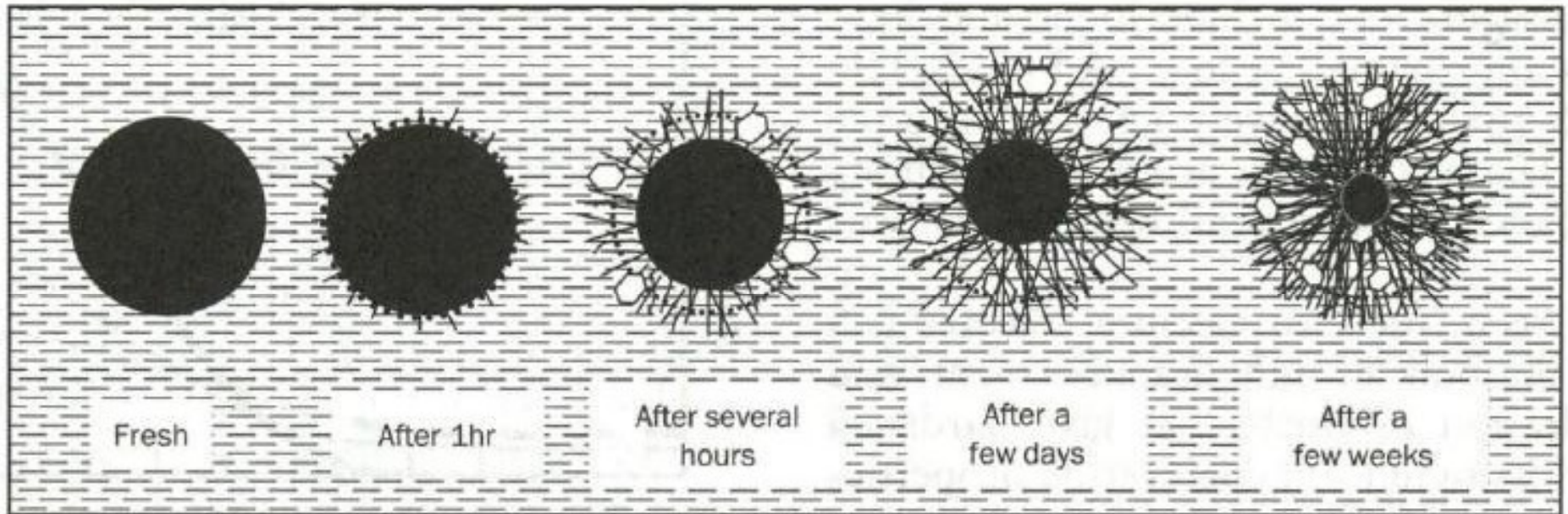
Reaction between cement particles and water

- **Change in matter**
 - Cement Hydration Products formed
 - Decrease in porosity
- **Change in energy level**
 - Heat is generated; Temperature rise
- **Rate of reaction**
 - **Composition** and **Fineness** of cement
 - Increased with the increase in **temperature**
 - Decrease with the increase in **time**
 - Decrease with the decrease in **moisture content**

When Water Is Added to Cement, What Happens?

- Dissolution of cement grains
- Growing ionic concentration in “water” (now a solution)
- Formation of compounds in solution
- After reaching a saturation concentration, compounds precipitate out as solids (“hydration products”)
- In later stages, products form on or very near the surface of the anhydrous cement

Hydration of A Cement Grain With Time



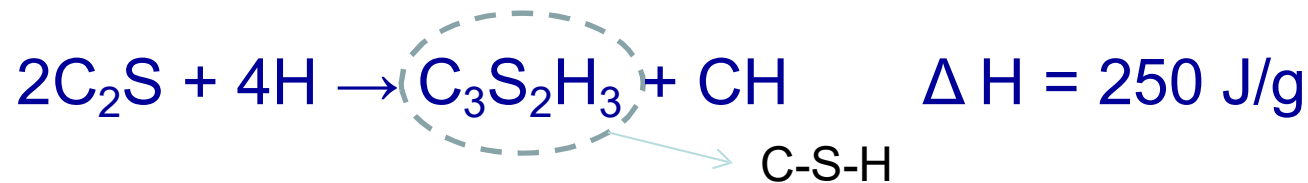
 Mix water

 Unhydrated cement

 Hydrates (mainly C-S-H)

 Portlandite crystals

Hydration of Calcium Silicates (75% of Cement)



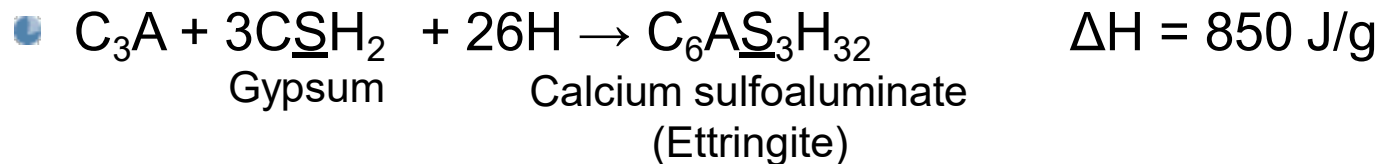
- C_3S hydration is **more rapid and evolves more heat**
 - C_3S is responsible for the setting of cement (or concrete) and contributes to **early age strength** (2-3 hrs to 14 days)
- C_2S hydration occurs **more slowly and contributes to later age strength** after ~7-14 days
- C_3S produces more CH (source for sulfate attack, a durability concern)

Hydration of Tricalcium Aluminate

- Pure C_3A hydrates rapidly and produce flash set



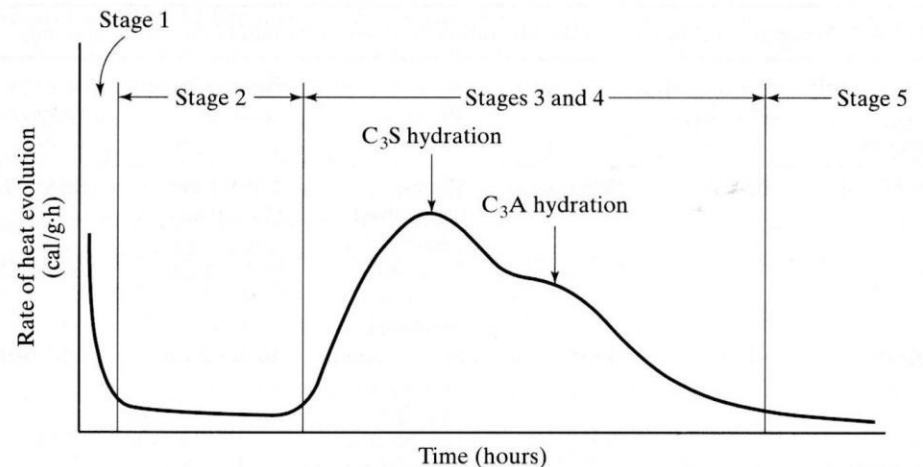
- In the presence of gypsum, C_3A hydration is controlled and flash setting is avoided



- Additional C_3A is a source for sulfate attack
- The aluminates hydrates faster than silicates with increased heat of hydration

Heat of Hydration of Cement

- The hydration reaction of Portland cement are all exothermic, meaning liberates heat
- Quantity of heat evolved depends on
 - Chemical composition
 - Temperature
 - Age of cement
- Heat evolved (J/g)



$$H = a \cdot C_3S + b \cdot C_2S + c \cdot C_3A + d \cdot C_4AF$$

a (= 502J/g), b (= 260J/g), c (= 867J/g), d (= 419J/g)
are heat of hydration for the respective compounds

Oxide	Cement A	Cement B	Cement C
Silica	22.4	25.0	20.7
Lime	68.2	61.0	64.2
Iron	0.3	3.0	5.3
Alumina	4.6	4.0	3.9
SO ₃	2.4	2.5	2.0
Free lime	3.3	1.0	1.5

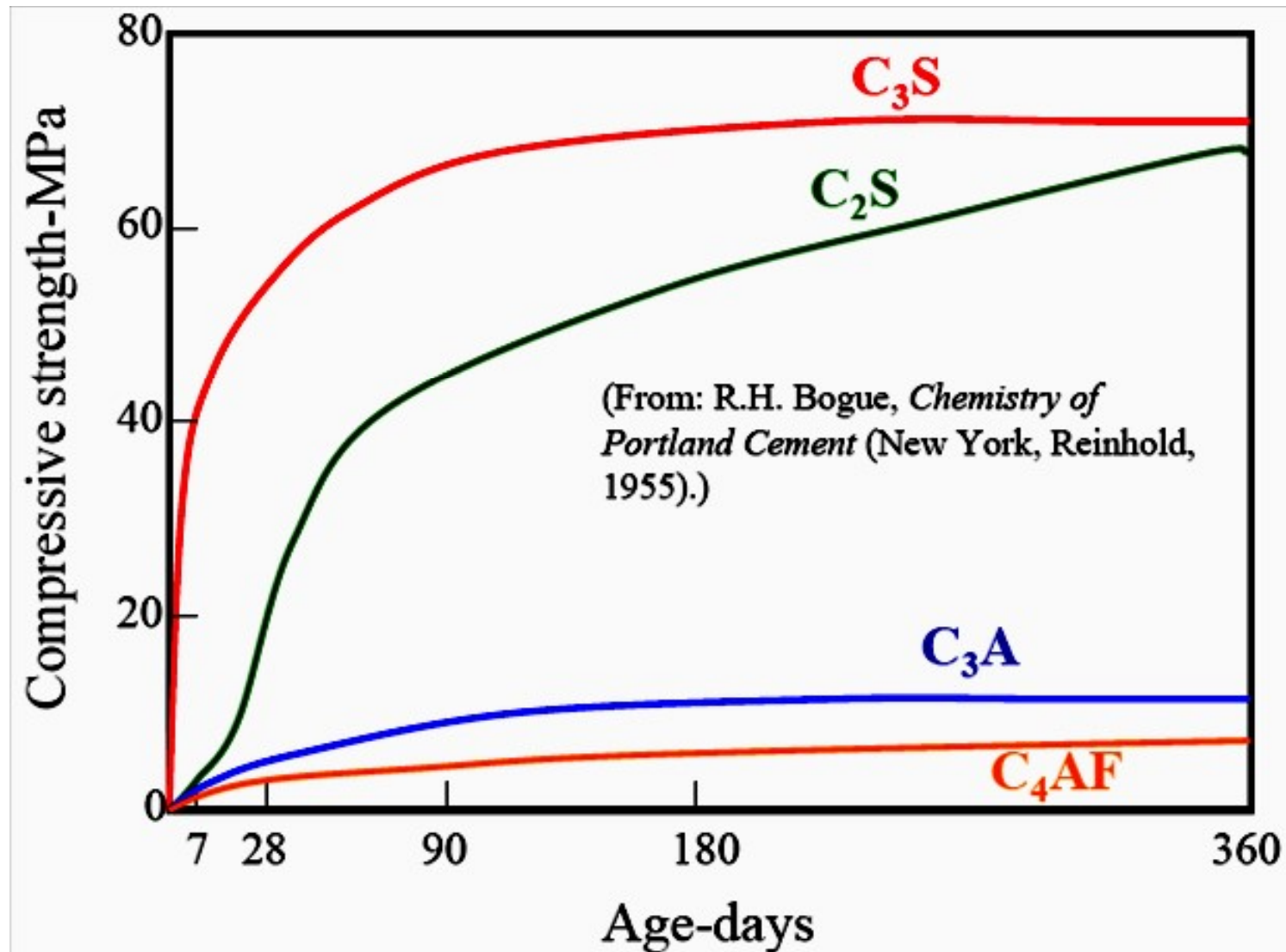
Using Bogue's equation, determine the major chemical compounds of these cements and highlight the expected performance of the concrete mixes of a given composition when these cements were used, with reference to the following: (i) rate of strength development; (ii) sulfate attack; and (iii) temperature increase in a thick concrete section.

(b) Assuming the heat of hydration of C_3S , C_2S , C_3A , and C_4AF are 500, 260, 860, and 420 kJ/kg, respectively, determine the heat of hydration for these cements

Major compounds contents (%) of three cements

Compound	Cement A	Cement B	Cement C
C_3S	69.15	19.98	64.49
C_2S	12.42	56.77	11.04
C_3A	11.68	5.53	1.38
C_4FA	0.91	9.12	16.11

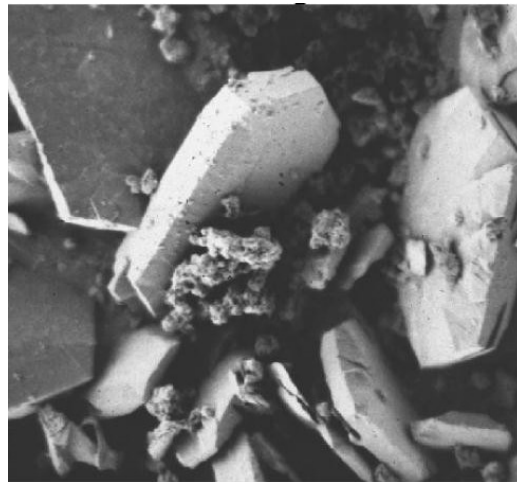
Strength development of major chemical compounds



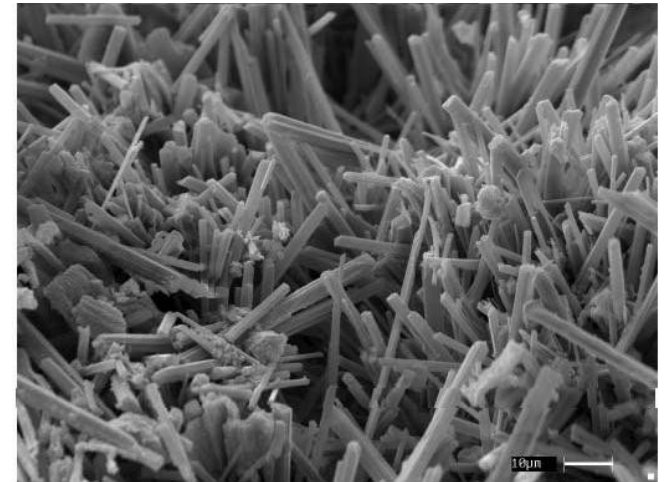
Microstructure of Hydration Products



C-S-H



Calcium Hydroxide



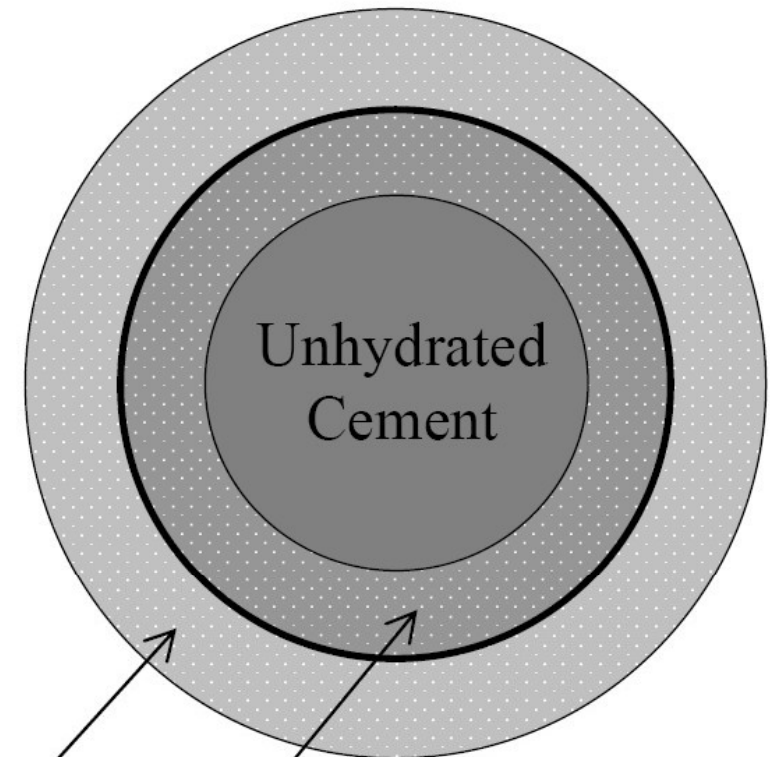
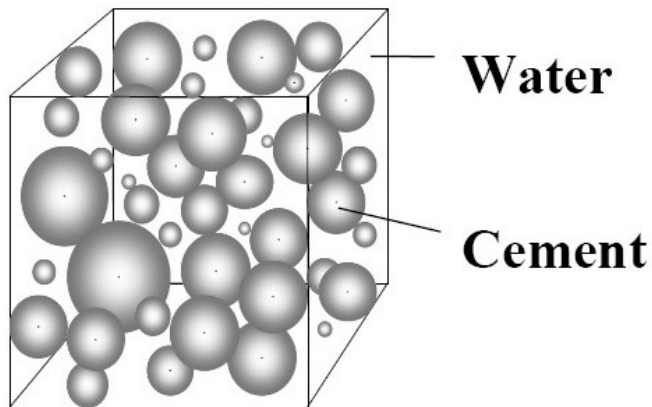
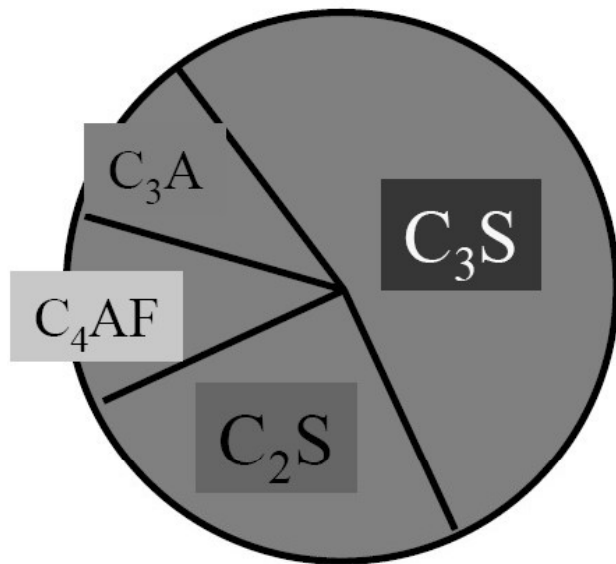
Ettringite

Characteristics of Hydration Products

Phase	% by Vol.	Strength	Remarks
Calcium Silicate Hydrate (C-S-H)	50 – 60	Provides major cohesive force	
Calcium Hydroxide (CH)	20 – 25	Reduces porosity	Causes sulfate attack
Calcium Sulfoaluminates ($C_6\text{AS}_3\text{H}_{32}$)	15 – 20	Not significant	Causes sulfate attack
Unhydrated cement	~ 5	Significant only in low porosity pastes	

Volume Changes During Hydration

Original cement particle



Outer
Hydration
product

Inner
Hydration
product

Hydration products:

$C-S-H$

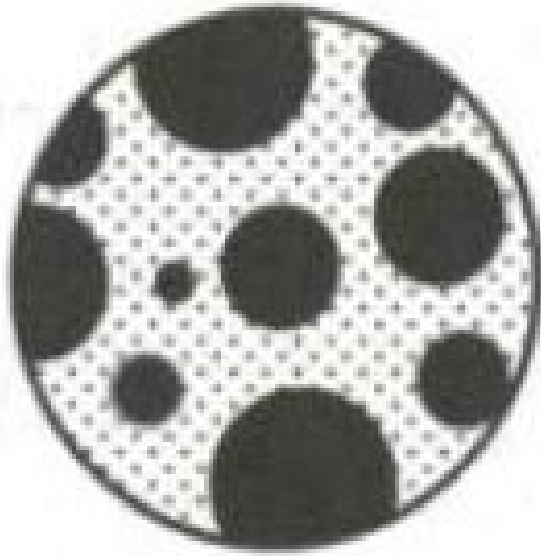
CH

$C_6A\underline{S}_3H_{32}$

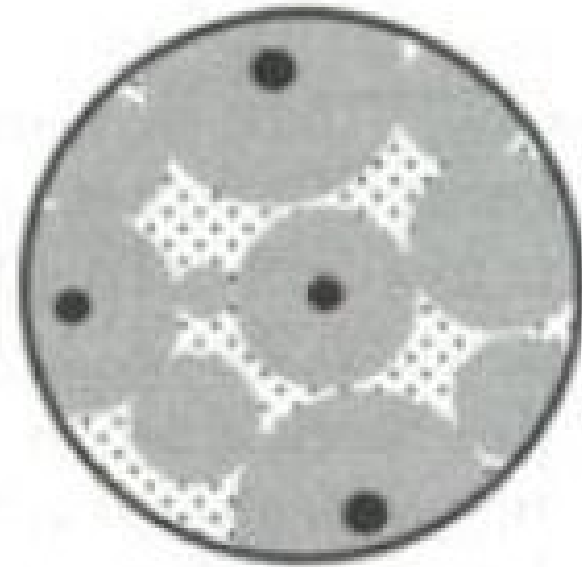
$C_4A\underline{S}H_{12}$

Volume of hydration product = 2.14x volume of cement

Structure of Cement Paste



Fresh



Several months old



Mix water in
capillary pores

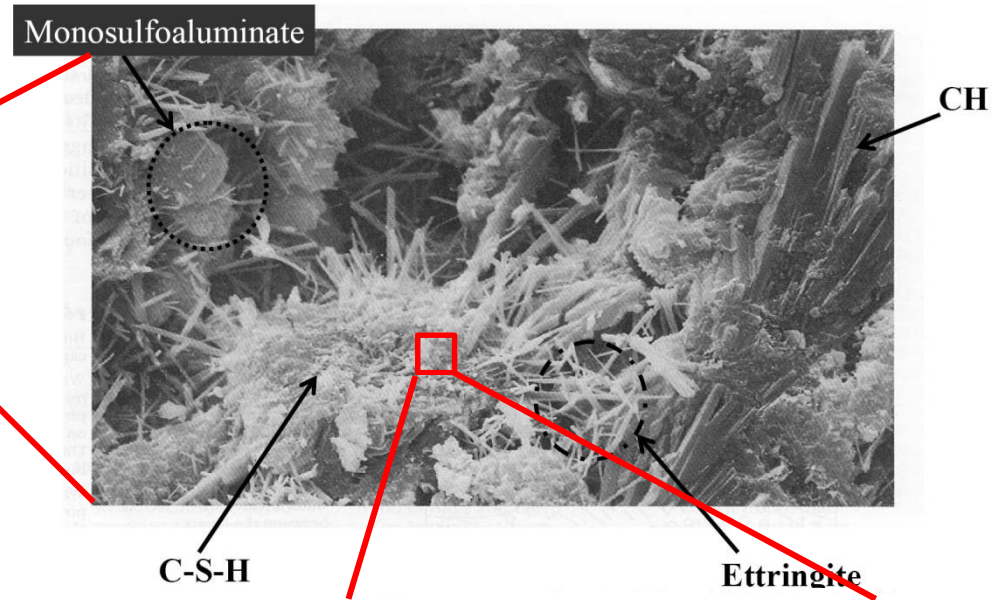
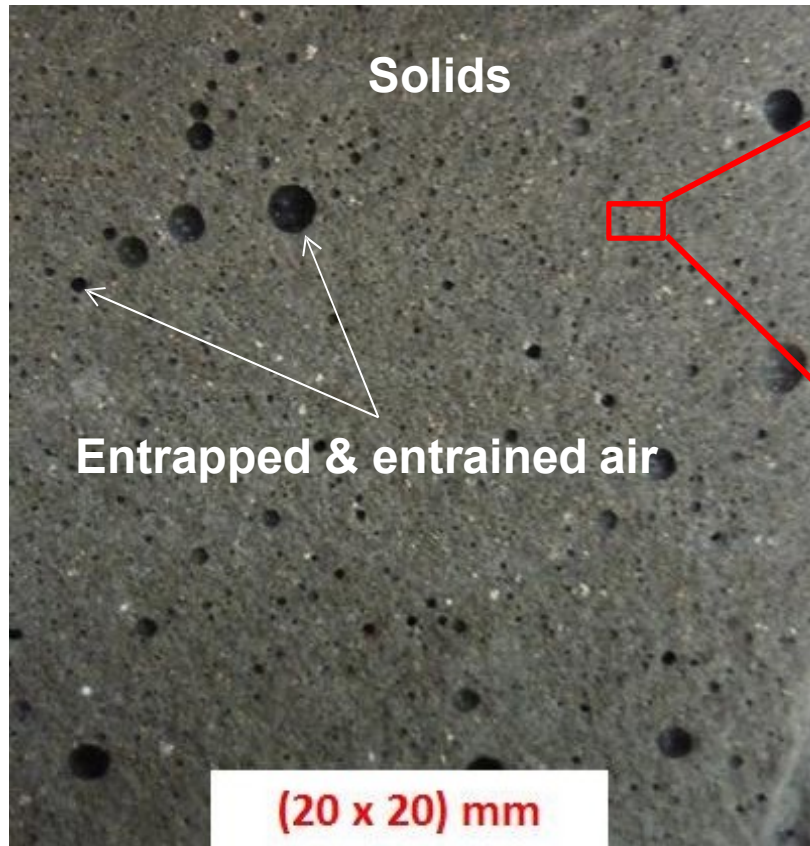


Unhydrated
cement



Hydrates
(gel)

Structure of Hydrated Cement Paste



C-S-H
layered
structure

I, M: Gel pores
P: Capillary voids

